

Vietnam: Digital Economy

■ Overview: Market Size Continues to Expand

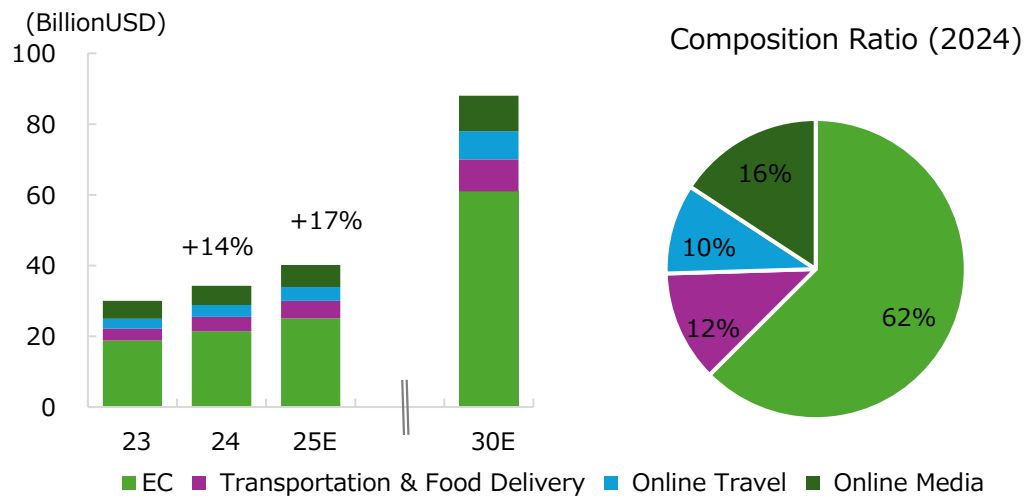
- Vietnam's digital economy market size continues to expand at a steady pace. In the financial sector, digital payments centered around QR codes are gaining widespread adoption.
- The government is also actively supporting the development of the digital economy. The 'National Digital Transformation (DX) Program' promulgated in 2020 explicitly sets the goal of becoming an "advanced digital nation" by 2030. To achieve this target, the government is promoting the development of related infrastructure and supporting the digitalization of businesses.
- Amid a wave of data center establishment across major ASEAN countries supporting the digital economy, Vietnam currently has the smallest data center scale. However, significant room for future expansion is anticipated.

■ GMV

- According to the 2025 edition of the 'e-Conomy' report on Southeast Asia's digital economy, jointly compiled by Google, Temasek, and Bain & Company, Vietnam's Gross Merchandise Value (GMV) in the digital economy sector (※) reached USD 34 billion in 2024, a 14% increase year-on-year. E-commerce accounted for approximately 60% of this total, growing 14% to USD 21 billion. Beyond e-commerce, online media saw single-digit growth, while transportation/food delivery and online travel both demonstrated double-digit growth.
- Total GMV for 2025 is projected to grow by 17% to USD 39 billion, continuing double-digit expansion. E-commerce, the largest segment, is forecast to expand by 17% to USD 25 billion (Figure 1).

※Comprising: ◇E-commerce, ◇Transportation/Food Delivery, ◇Online Travel, ◇Online Media (Advertising, Gaming, Video/Music), ◇Financial Services. Total transaction value excludes Financial Services.

Figure 1: Digital Economy GMV



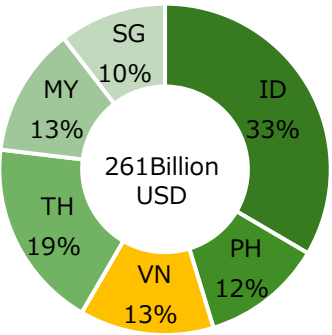
(source : Google, Temasek, and Bain & Company's 'e-Conomy SEA 2025')

■ GMV Country Composition Ratio

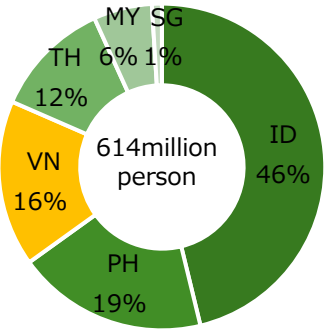
- In 2024, the GMV of the six Southeast Asian countries increased by 15% year-on-year to USD 261 billion, with Vietnam accounting for 13% of this total. This is roughly the same scale as Malaysia, making it the third-largest market after Indonesia and Thailand.
- By sector, Vietnam holds a relatively large share in online media, accounting for nearly 20% of the total (Figure 2). Games, primarily mobile games, are driving market expansion.

Figure 2: GMV Composition by Country (2024)

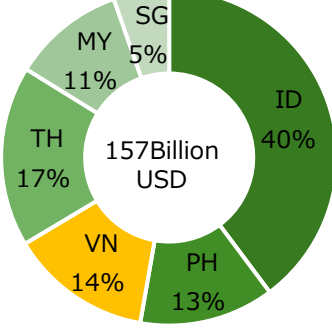
Total GMV



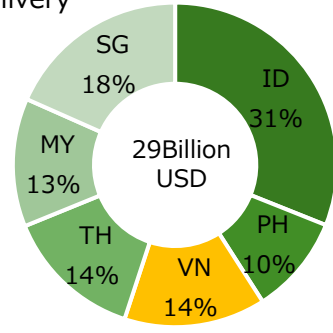
<Reference> Population



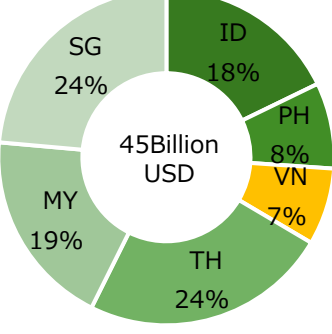
E-commerce



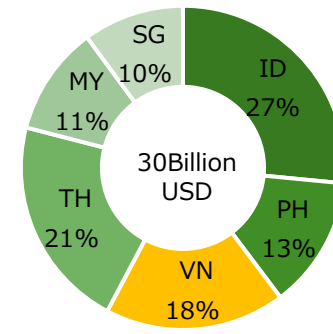
Transportation & Food Delivery



Online Travel



Online Media



(source : Google, Temasek, Bain & Company 'e-Economy SEA 2025')

■ Digital Payments

- Among digital financial services, the total value of digital payments in 2024 increased by 19% to USD 178 billion. This growth rate was the third highest after Indonesia and the Philippines, with a 13% share across the six countries (Figure 3).
- Major ASEAN countries are uniformly promoting the adoption of QR code payments led by their central banks. In Indonesia and the Philippines, private sector operators are complying with central bank standards, integrating and consolidating their services into the standard QR code.
- In contrast, Vietnam sees coexistence between the central bank-led standardized QR code payment system (VietQR) and private-sector-led QR code payment services (like MoMo). Full integration has not been achieved. The State Bank of Vietnam (SBV) aims to standardize QR codes and ensure interoperability, with achieving compatibility between different standards being a key challenge (Figure 4).

Figure 3: Total Digital Payments

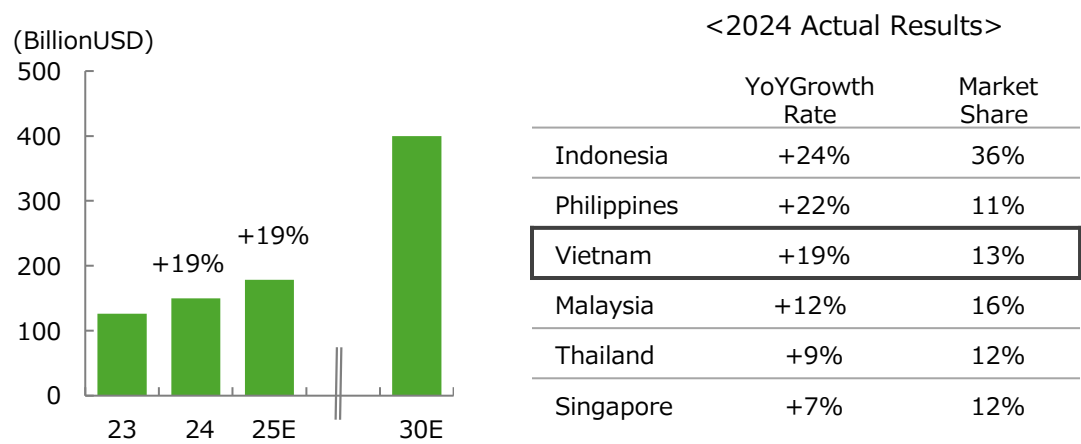


Figure 4: QR Code Payment System Overview

	Vietnam	Indonesia	Philippines
Standard Name	VietQR	QRIS (Quick Response Code Indonesia Standard)	QR Ph (National QR Code Standard)
Lead Agency	State Bank of Vietnam (SBV)	Bank Indonesia (BI)	Central Bank of the Philippines (BSP)
Standardization Level	Low (Centralized VietQR and private QR codes coexist)	High (Nationwide standardization, mandatory usage)	High (Mandatory transition)
Private Sector Collaboration	Private wallets/banks may use proprietary QR codes concurrently	Private sector businesses must comply with QRIS	Major operators like GCash and Maya transition to QR Ph
Interoperability	Limited (Compatibility between standards is an issue)	High (Interoperable via common QR)	High

(source : Google, Temasek, Bain & Company 'e-Conomy SEA 2025')

■ Data Center Installation Plans

- Amid growing demand for data centers driven by the proliferation of generative AI, major ASEAN countries are increasing data center investments. Currently, Singapore boasts the largest data center capacity, but its growth potential is limited due to constraints like resource supply.
- Vietnam, on the other hand, has the smallest existing data center footprint but plans to build new data centers with capacity equivalent to twice its current size (Figure 5).
- Recent developments include the Ministry of Public Security commencing operations of a national data center in Hanoi in August 2025. Also in August 2025, Vietnam's CMC Technology Group agreed with Samsung C&T to build a data center in Ho Chi Minh City.

Figure 5: Data Center Scale

	MW		Expansion/Existing
	Existing	Expansion Plans	
Singapore	1,000	300	+30%
Malaysia	690	2,415	+350%
Thailand	350	700	+200%
Indonesia	330	825	+250%
Philippines	180	270	+150%
Vietnam	55	110	+200%

(source : Google, Temasek, Bain & Company 'e-Conomy SEA 2025')

(Ashu Research : December 2025)